

## Background

Since the late 1970s, the BirdLife Partnership has worked collectively to identify, document and effectively conserve the sites of greatest significance for the conservation of the world's birds. Important Bird and Biodiversity Areas (IBAs) are sites that are significant for the long-term viability of naturally occurring bird populations, and many are also important for other forms of biodiversity. More recently, the Key Biodiversity Areas (KBAs) concept was developed to identify 'sites of significance for the global persistence of biodiversity'. The scientifically robust single standard used to identify KBAs was strongly based on the criteria used to identify IBAs. The KBA Partnership comprises 13 international conservation organisations, including BirdLife, and was officially launched in September 2016 to promote the identification of KBAs.

The identification of IBAs and KBAs draws upon the efforts of huge networks of local experts, and relies on locally collected, ground-truthed data that are analysed nationally to establish each site's biodiversity significance and its conservation management potential. IBA and KBA identification and delineation is based on the application of standard, internationally recognized criteria to the most up-to-date knowledge of species' populations and distribution. The use of standard criteria worldwide means the IBAs and KBAs can be considered "common currency" throughout the world.

Currently, the global network of >13,000 IBAs forms the largest share of the >16,000 KBAs published on the KBA website. The global datasets on IBAs and KBAs are managed by BirdLife International on behalf of the BirdLife and KBA Partnerships respectively.

Most BirdLife Partners around the world continue to promote both IBAs and KBAs as a basis for their sites work in their countries, although some Partners have opted to progress their sites work solely through KBA processes.

## Data sources

The data on sites of importance for birds shown on the BirdLife DataZone, and available upon request, primarily relate to confirmed IBAs. For 55 countries (listed in Annex 1) that have opted to progress their sites work through KBAs only and/or that have undertaken recent updates of KBAs but not IBAs, the data relate to KBAs that have been confirmed for at least one bird qualifying species, and are sourced from the World Database of KBAs.

For the majority of sites, spatial data defining site boundaries are provided in a polygon layer; for a small number of sites for which boundaries have not yet been delineated, centroids are provided in a layer of point localities in a separate layer. Further details on the attributes presented in the spatial data are provided in Annex 2.

## Citation

BirdLife International (2025) Digital boundaries of Important Bird and Biodiversity Areas (IBAs) and Key Biodiversity Areas (KBAs) identified for birds. September 2025 version. BirdLife International, Cambridge, UK. Available at: <https://datazone.birdlife.org/contact-us/request-our-data>

## Terms of use

The Terms of Use for IBA data are provided at <https://datazone.birdlife.org/info/dataterms>. The Terms of Use for KBA data are provided at <https://www.keybiodiversityareas.org/termsofservice>.

**Annex 1: Countries whose data on sites of importance for birds are sourced from the KBA dataset managed in the World Database of KBAs**

|                                              |                                             |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>American Samoa</b>                        | <b>Mozambique</b>                           |
| <b>Angola</b>                                | <b>Nauru</b>                                |
| <b>Australia</b>                             | <b>New Caledonia</b>                        |
| <b>Bolivia, Plurinational State of</b>       | <b>New Zealand</b>                          |
| <b>Burkina Faso</b>                          | <b>Nigeria</b>                              |
| <b>Cameroon</b>                              | <b>Niue</b>                                 |
| <b>Canada</b>                                | <b>Norfolk Island</b>                       |
| <b>Christmas Island</b>                      | <b>Northern Mariana Islands</b>             |
| <b>Colombia</b>                              | <b>Palau</b>                                |
| <b>Congo</b>                                 | <b>Papua New Guinea</b>                     |
| <b>Congo, The Democratic Republic of the</b> | <b>Peru</b>                                 |
| <b>Cook Islands</b>                          | <b>Pitcairn</b>                             |
| <b>Ecuador</b>                               | <b>São Tomé and Príncipe</b>                |
| <b>Egypt</b>                                 | <b>Samoa</b>                                |
| <b>Fiji</b>                                  | <b>Solomon Islands</b>                      |
| <b>French Polynesia</b>                      | <b>South Africa</b>                         |
| <b>Gabon</b>                                 | <b>Tanzania</b>                             |
| <b>Ghana</b>                                 | <b>Tokelau</b>                              |
| <b>Guam</b>                                  | <b>Tonga</b>                                |
| <b>Kenya</b>                                 | <b>Tunisia</b>                              |
| <b>Kiribati</b>                              | <b>Uganda</b>                               |
| <b>Liberia</b>                               | <b>United Arab Emirates</b>                 |
| <b>Libyan Arab Jamahiriya</b>                | <b>United States Minor Outlying Islands</b> |
| <b>Madagascar</b>                            | <b>Vanuatu</b>                              |
| <b>Malawi</b>                                | <b>Wallis and Futuna</b>                    |
| <b>Marshall Islands</b>                      | <b>Zambia</b>                               |
| <b>Mauritius</b>                             | <b>Zimbabwe</b>                             |
| <b>Micronesia, Federated States of</b>       |                                             |

## Annex 2: Attributes of spatial data.

| Field name        | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>SitRecID</b>   | Unique Site ID                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Region</b>     | BirdLife Region                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Country</b>    | Country/territory name                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>ISO3</b>       | ISO 3166-1 three letter country code                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>NatName</b>    | National Site Name                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>IntName</b>    | International Site Name                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>SitLat</b>     | Latitude centroid coordinate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>SitLong</b>    | Longitude centroid coordinate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>SitAreaKm2</b> | Areas presented in square kilometres (km <sup>2</sup> ) using area calculator (Geodesic). Areas were calculated in the WGS84 geographic coordinate system (Decimal Degrees projection (Latitude, Longitude) and datum WGS84) – called Geographic Projection–World-WGS84 in ArcGIS 10 and WGS 84 coordinate Reference (EPSG:4326) in QGIS.                                                                                                     |
| <b>RepAreaKm2</b> | Reported area of the site (in km <sup>2</sup> )                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>KbaStatus</b>  | KBA Status                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>KbaClass</b>   | The classification of all KBAs is assigned as <i>Global</i> (KBAs that meet KBA criteria), <i>Regional</i> (KBAs identified prior to the KBA Standard that meet other pre-existing criteria) or <i>Global/Regional TBD</i> (KBAs identified prior to the KBA Standard using pre-existing criteria but with insufficient evidence to show whether they continue to meet criteria. Sites in this latter group are prioritised for reassessment) |
| <b>IbaStatus</b>  | IBA Status                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>AzeStatus</b>  | AZE Status                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>LastUpdate</b> | Year of most recent site assessment                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Source</b>     | Origin of data                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>DelTxt</b>     | Description of how the site was digitised                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>SitSource</b>  | Data source – ‘IBA’ = ‘Important Bird and Biodiversity Areas’ or ‘KBA’ = Key Biodiversity Areas (KBAs) triggered by bird species                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

